

Topic 1: Introduction to AI Writing Tools

1.1 What AI Writing Tools Do

- AI writing tools generate, rewrite, summarise, and edit text based on your instructions
- They are most effective at: eliminating the blank page, producing first drafts, creating variations, and handling formulaic writing
- They are not effective at: original research, verified facts, unique personal experience, or strategic judgement
- Best mental model: AI as a very fast first-draft writer and editor -- you are still the strategist, fact-checker, and final author
- Human writer + AI = faster output with broader reach, not AI replacing the human entirely

1.2 Main AI Writing Tools

- ChatGPT (chat.openai.com): best general-purpose writing assistant; handles almost any writing task
- Claude (claude.ai): strong for long-form writing, nuanced tone, and following complex style instructions
- Jasper (jasper.ai): dedicated marketing copy platform with brand voice training features (paid)
- Copy.ai (copy.ai): focused on short-form marketing copy -- ads, product descriptions, social posts (free tier)
- Grammarly (grammarly.com): AI grammar, tone, clarity, and style suggestions integrated into your browser and apps
- Hemingway Editor (hemingwayapp.com): readability analysis -- highlights complex sentences, passive voice, and adverbs

1.3 What to Expect from AI Output

- Treat every AI output as a rough first draft -- it requires human review and editing before use
- AI does not know your brand voice, audience, or internal context unless you provide it explicitly in the prompt
- Factual claims need independent verification -- AI generates plausible-sounding but sometimes incorrect information
- Generic-sounding output means the prompt lacked specificity -- add more context, examples, and constraints
- Over-reliance produces content that sounds like everyone else's AI content -- add unique insight and examples

1.4 Disclosure and Academic Integrity

- Many publications, platforms, and academic institutions now require disclosure of AI assistance
 - Best practice: be transparent -- 'This article was drafted with AI assistance and reviewed/edited by [name]'
 - Most universities have explicit AI policies for coursework -- check your institution's current policy
 - Major journalism outlets (AP, Reuters, NYT) have published editorial AI policies; check if your field has guidance
 - The responsible use of AI in writing requires human oversight, editing, and accountability for the final output
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